

# The Impacts of Sustainable Tourism in Koh Kong

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## I. Introduction

The report delves into the implication of sustainable tourism in Koh Kong, with a dual objective: firstly, to enlighten our communication skills lecturer, Mrs. Rolitess Galam Hourng, about sustainable tourism in Koh Kong. Secondly, it serves as an informative guide for both local and international tourists interested in exploring Koh Kong, highlighting its eco-friendly attractions, amenities, accommodations, and more, with the aspiration of enticing them to visit. The information presented herein is meticulously sourced from reputable and reliable sources, incorporating data, statistics, and figures. Additionally, our research includes insights gleaned from interviews with both locals and foreigners, capturing their experiences of traveling in Koh Kong. The body of the report will begin by offering background information about Koh Kong, followed by an overview of sustainable tourism practices in the region. It will then highlight the range of facilities and amenities available to tourists, including accommodations, restaurant options, and various tourist activities. Special emphasis will be placed on popular attractions and destinations in Koh Kong. Moreover, the report will feature Ministry of tourism data and tourism infographics. Subsequently, profiles of both local and foreign tourists, gathered through interviews conducted by our group members, will be presented as primary sources, detailing their experiences in Koh Kong. To conclude, a summary will be provided, accompanied by recommendations for enhancing Koh Kong's appeal as a tourist destination, along with a list of sources utilized in the report.

## II. The Impact of Sustainable Tourism in Koh Kong

### A. Background information about Koh Kong

Koh Kong, situated as Cambodia's southwestern province, stands out as one of the largest provinces in the country, boasting an extensive undeveloped coastline and a rugged, forested interior that include a portion of the Cardamom Mountains, Southeast Asia's largest contiguous rainforest. The province offers a rich tapestry of attractions, from diverse wildlife and impressive waterfalls to border-side casinos with Thailand. Additionally, it is witnessing development with the establishment of an Export Processing Zone and modern port facilities, facilitating international trade. (Tourism Cambodia, 2024)

The province has become a popular entry point to Cambodia from Hat Lek in southern Thailand, mainly due to its convenient access to the port and beach resort town of Sihanoukville. Previously, the journey was arduous, involving boat rides and traveling on rough, bumpy roads with small ferries at river crossings. However, thanks to the donation of new road infrastructure by the Thai government, access has significantly improved. (Tourism Cambodia, 2024)

The province is named "Krong Island Province" and its capital, Krong Koh Kong, is situated in the western part of the province near the Thai border. The city is surrounded by expansive forested areas, connected to the mainland via bridges and ferries. Although Krong Koh Kong is generally tranquil, there are numerous attractions that make it worth staying for more than just a night, such as nearby islands, rivers, nature tours, and lively nightlife. (Tourism Cambodia, 2024)

The inhabitants of Koh Kong primarily speak Khmer, with many also having some proficiency in Thai. Additionally, there are significant numbers of Chinese and Vietnamese speakers, along with a considerable amount of broken English spoken. Visitors can expect affordable accommodation, food, and transportation in Koh Kong, making it an economical destination. (Tourism Cambodia, 2024)

### B. Overview of Sustainable Tourism in Koh Kong

Sustainable tourism involves acknowledging and being accountable for the effects your actions may have on the environment during your travels. It entails being mindful of the surroundings you encounter and showing respect towards the communities you explore. (Frommer's, 2024) Sustainable tourism in Koh Kong is a concerted effort to promote tourism while minimizing negative impacts on the environment and local communities, ensuring long-term viability and equitable benefits. This approach entails fostering responsible tourism practices that preserve Koh Kong's natural resources, such as its pristine beaches, lush rainforests,

and diverse wildlife. Initiatives prioritize low-impact activities like hiking, bird watching, and wildlife observing, which allow visitors to appreciate the region's biodiversity without causing harm. Accommodations and infrastructure are designed with eco-friendly principles in mind, implementing measures to reduce waste, conserve energy, and protect water resources. Moreover, sustainable tourism in Koh Kong emphasizes cultural preservation, with efforts to showcase local traditions, heritage, and craftsmanship through cultural festivals, handicraft workshops, and heritage tours. And Koh Kong strives to ensure that tourism contributes positively to its development while safeguarding its natural and cultural heritage for future generations to enjoy.

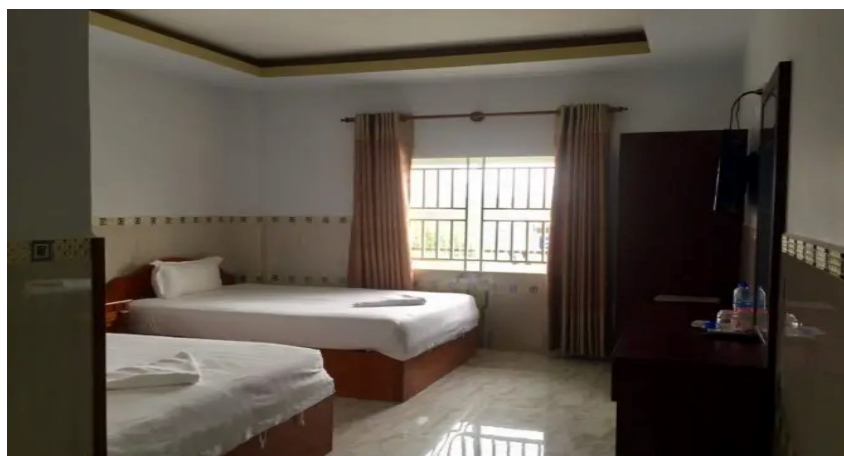
### C. Tourist Facilities and Amenities

Koh Kong is located at the southwestern tip of the country near the mouth of the Kah Bpow River in Smach Mean Chey district on the Gulf of Thailand, the city is only 10 kilometers from the Thai border. (Ministry of Tourism, Cambodia, 2024) Although this province might not be well-known as some other tourist destinations in Cambodia. The facilities and amenities still provide guests with a variety of services. There are a few places with the tourism facilities, amenities and services you can find in Koh Kong.

#### 1) Accommodation

Accommodations options here in Koh Kong have many choices. People can find small hotels that are nice to the environment and are close to nature. Some places are like cozy little houses near the beach where you can see the sea. Many places in Koh Kong try to be kind to the environment by not wasting things and helping local people. No matter if people want a quiet place in the middle of the jungle or a small house near the beach, Koh Kong has something for everyone.

Nathy Koh Kong Hotel (opened mid-2017) is located on the main street near the roundabout. This is conveniently located within a short stroll from shops, eateries, and the market, and just ten minutes away from the riverside. Room rates vary, starting from \$8 per night for a Superior Double room with a fan, up to \$20 for a Superior Double room with air conditioning. (Korteling, 2020)

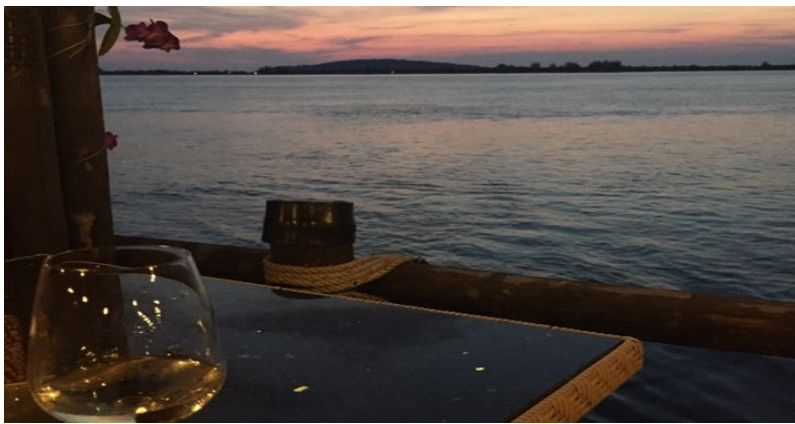


(Korteling, 2020) Nathy Koh Kong Hotel

## 2) Dining

In Koh Kong, dining options abound, catering to various tastes. From traditional Khmer delicacies, international cuisines, and street food stalls, there's a culinary delight for everyone. Whether you prefer local eateries, international restaurants, or vibrant street markets, Koh Kong offers a diverse dining experience that promises to satisfy everyone.

Café Laurent with main dishes priced between \$5 to \$7. Their extensive menu includes a wide selection of Western options like pizzas and pastas, alongside Asian dishes ranging from Thai to Khmer. Even if you're on a tight budget, it's a splendid place to enjoy a sunset with a beer or wine. The outdoor seating area, a shaded wooden walkway over the water, combines local charm with sophistication, while indoors, there's a sleek bar for cocktails. The service is attentive and professional. (Travelfish.org, 2024)



(Travelfish.org, 2024)

Sunset at Café Laurent

## 3) Transportation

In Koh Kong, transportation mainly relies on tuk-tuks, motorcycle, taxis, boat, buses, and rental bicycles. Tuk-tuks are popular for short trips, while motorcycles, taxis, and buses offer faster rides for longer distances. Rental bicycles are available for independent exploration as well. Private car hire and organized tours are also options for those wanting more comfort or visiting remote areas. And you can use booking apps such as Grab and Passapp. (Tourism of Cambodia, 2024)



(Tourism Cambodia, 2024)

Mekong Express



## 4) Shopping

Most goods are brought in from Thailand, except for locally sourced vegetables, fruits, and certain food items. Additionally, on the eastern side of the market, there are a few clothing stores selling Thai-made clothes. Furthermore, some small shops along the southern side of the market remain open until 10pm at night. (Tourism of Cambodia, 2024)



(Tourism of Cambodia, 2024) Market in Koh Kong

## D. Tourist Destination

Considering its natural beauty, Koh Kong is still one of Cambodia's remote provinces that has a lot of destinations tourist can visit, allowing tourists an opportunity to expose themselves to interact with nature.

### 1) Tatai Waterfall

The picturesque Tatai Waterfalls are a major attraction in Koh Kong, attracting numerous travelers seeking natural beauty. Visitors could hike up to the various small falls and enjoy a revitalizing swim in the pristine waters. Besides swimming, guests can bring along a packed lunch to enjoy a scenic picnic on the large rocks near the falls. With its tranquil ambiance, the Tatai Waterfalls offer a serene getaway that should not be overlooked. For those seeking a unique experience, arrangements can be made for boat rides or kayaking excursions to reach the falls. Returning from the falls during sunset adds an extra layer of enchantment to the journey. (Ministry of Tourism, Cambodia, 2024)



(Ministry of Tourism, Cambodia, 2024)

Tatai Waterfall



## 2) Koh Mool Resort (Kor Kong Krav)

Referred to as Cambodia's biggest island, Koh Mool is conveniently located just a quick journey away from the delightful town of Koh Kong. In addition to the serene getaways it offers, Koh Mool boasts breathtaking waterfalls and various small springs for visitors to explore. Travelers can also partake in dolphin watching activities. For families with young children, there's the added delight of a dolphin show organized by Koh Mool Resort (Kor Kong Krav). Taking a stroll along the beach under the moonlight promises to be a memorable experience. (Ministry of Tourism, Cambodia, 2024)



(Ministry of Tourism, Cambodia, 2024) Koh Mool Resort (Koh Kong Krav)

## 3) Khun Chhalgn Khun Phen Resort

The Khun Chhalgn Khun Phen Resort sits strategically facing Koh Kong's provincial town. It features a Stupa positioned on a large rock amidst the expansive blue sea, serving as a central gathering spot for locals during festive occasions. International visitors also frequent the resort, particularly during traditional festivals, to explore Cambodia's rich cultural heritage. (Ministry of Tourism, Cambodia, 2024)



(Ministry of Tourism, Cambodia, 2024) Khun Chhalgn Khun Phen Resort

#### 4) Lam Da Beach

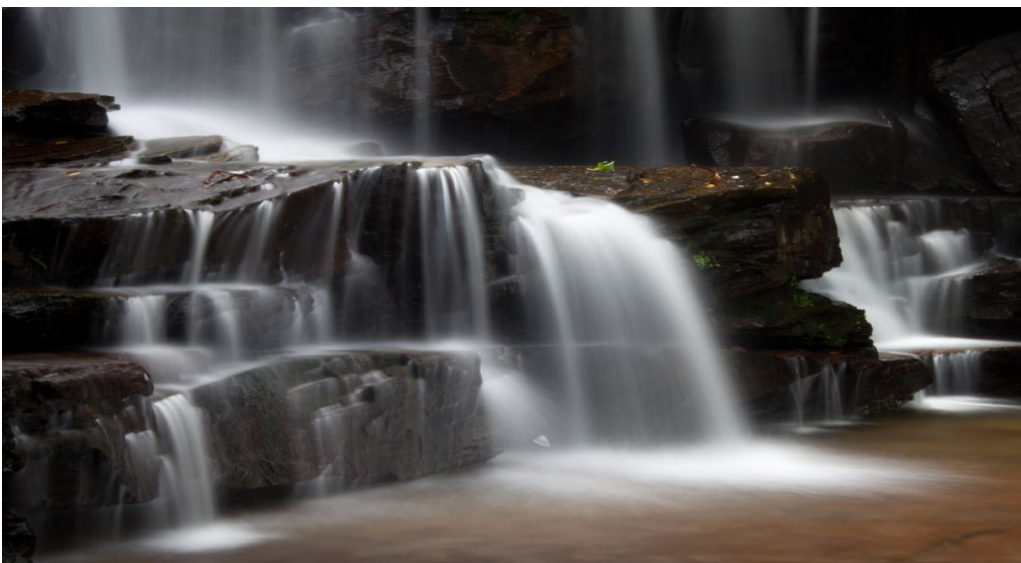
At Lam Da Beach, you can enjoy the sea, sand, and peaceful atmosphere. The long golden beach, bathed in sunlight, is loved by both young and old visitors. It's about a one hour and forty-five minutes drive from the provincial town and is located around twenty kilometers away. Both kids and adults will have fun in the calm sea and beautiful scenery. (Ministry of Tourism, Cambodia, 2024)



(Ministry of Tourism, Cambodia, 2024) Lam Da Beach, Koh Kong

#### 5) Kbal Chhay Prek Koh Waterfall

The Kbal Chhay Prek Koh Waterfalls offer stunning views and a peaceful getaway that is in Neng Kok village, Bakclong Commune, Mundol Seyma District, Koh Kong province, they are about 22km from the heart of the province. Visitors can explore nature and wildlife reserves here, possibly spotting rare plants and animals. It's also a great spot for family picnics. (Ministry of Tourism, Cambodia, 2024)



(Ministry of Tourism, Cambodia, 2024) Kbal Chhay Prek Koh Waterfalls



## 6) Sner Beach

Sner Beach is a popular destination in Koh Kong, drawing visitors from around the world with its beautiful coastline. It's about 17 kilometers from downtown Koh Kong, in the Dong Tung commune of the Smachmeanchery District. The beach's natural beauty, away from city noise, keeps tourists coming back because they love it. (Ministry of Tourism, Cambodia, 2024)



(Ministry of Tourism, Cambodia, 2024) Sner Beach

## 7) Cham Yeam Resort

Cham Yeam Resort is found in Mondul Seima district, about 10 kilometers northwest of Koh Kong town, near the Cambodian-Thai border that created in 1997 by Neak Oknha Li Yong Phat, it's called Koh Kong international Resort. Today, it's a popular spot for tourists, especially from Thailand. This resort is known for its beauty, with five-star hotels, guesthouses, casinos, and the Koh Kong Safari World Zoo. Cham Yeam Beach is adorned with lovely coconut trees. The Cham Yeam border checkpoint is from 8am to 5pm and again from 10pm to 11pm for importing and exporting goods. (Tourism of Cambodia, 2024)

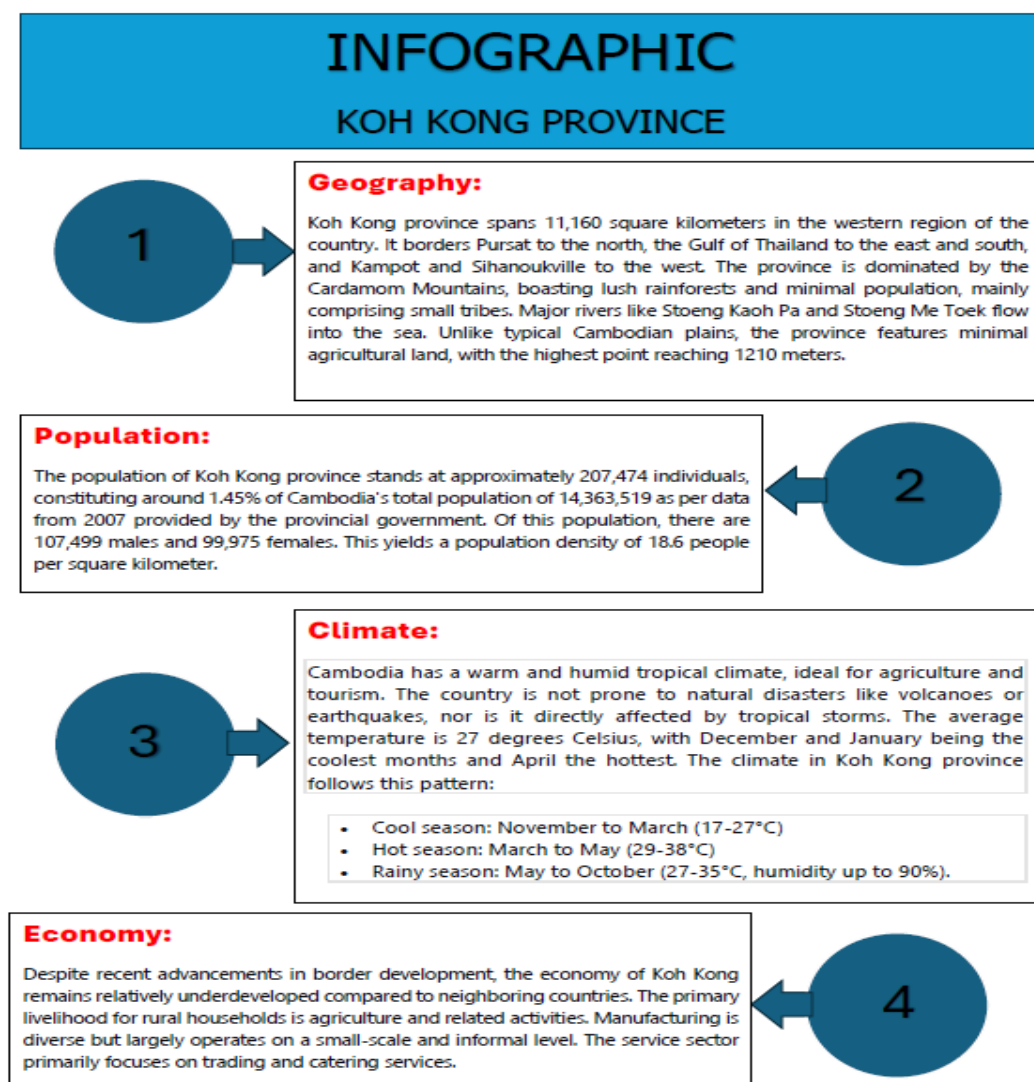


(Tourism of Cambodia, 2024) Cham Yeam Resort

## E. Statistics from the Ministry of Tourism

In the first two months of 2024, Cambodia experienced a nearly 20% surge foreign tourist arrivals compared to the same period in 2023, totaling 988,574 visitors. Notably, Thailand, Vietnam, China, and Laos contributed over 60% of the total arrivals. The increase is attributed to factors such as global economic recovery, tourism promotions, improved infrastructure, and enhanced flight connections. The influx of tourists has notably benefited job creation and income for stakeholders, particularly in Siem Reap province, where temple visits have seen a significant uptick. Additionally, Angkor Archeological Park witnessed a 50.27% increase in ticket sales during this period, generating \$11.23 million. While there is optimism among tour operators for continued growth, challenges remain, including the need to attract more Chinese tourists, who were previously a dominant visitor group before the pandemic. Despite this, Cambodia is now drawing visitors from a wider range of countries, indicating the country's growing appeal as a tourist destination. (The Phnom Penh Post, 2024)

## F. Tourism Infographic of Koh Kong



(Tourism Cambodia, 2024) Tourism Infographic (Made by: Chui Vanenteakbot)

## G. Profile of respondents

### **1. Profile of a University of Puthisastra (UP) student (local)**

Kim Roth Chakriya is a single 19-year-old student at University of Puthisastra, majoring in pharmacy. She typically spends approximately \$5 a day in Cambodia. As she mentioned, she travels abroad once a year if she has time, usually with a group of 4 or 5 family and friends. Also, in South-East Asia beside Cambodia, she has once travelled to Thailand. For the transportation, she rides her motorcycle around Phnom Penh, Cambodia. For booking apps, she sometimes uses PassApp or Grab if she doesn't ride her motorcycle. From what we discussed, she has never been to Koh Kong, but she has heard about a lot of beautiful islands and amazing views there. She's also planning to visit Koh Kong and if she were to go there, she might stay there for 3 days. The first things that come to her mind when hearing about Koh Kong are oceans, islands, resorts, and views there. Moreover, she has heard about Tatai Waterfall, Cardamom mountains, and Koh Kong Krav as well. And she would like to visit Tatai Waterfall because she heard that there are beautiful waterfalls there over the rocks and in the jungle, and it's a peaceful place where people can go to relax and enjoy nature. In addition, she mentioned that Tatai Waterfall offers many opportunities for eco-friendly activities such as hiking, bird watching, and exploring nearby forests. Also, she would like to visit Koh Kong Krav because she heard that visitors could enjoy pristine sand, clear water, and many opportunities for relaxation and beach activities. Regarding her opinions on what the city of Koh Kong should organize to enhance the visitor experience, she has mentioned that roads are hard to travel around Koh Kong, their lack of transportation options, and facilities that provide for tourists. And, she has mentioned that Koh Kong should have more advertisement because people barely know about it, and locals there should provide specific details for each tourist attraction such as prices, accommodation, and transportation purposely to assist tourists that plan to visit Koh Kong in the future.

(Interview by: Chui Vanenteakbot)

### **2. Profile of an American English Teacher (foreigner)**

Aaron is a single 38-year-old English teacher at Spring Education Center. He typically spends approximately \$10 a day in Cambodia for food, gas, etc. As he's now living in Cambodia, he travels abroad once a year. And he usually travels alone. He mentioned that the only country that he has visited in South-East Asia is Cambodia. He usually rides his motorbike around Phnom Penh, Cambodia. For booking apps, he has used BookMeBus if he needs to take a bus to go elsewhere. In fact, he has heard of Koh Kong before, but he's never been there. Nonetheless, he would love to go to Koh Kong because he heard that Koh Kong is a very beautiful province. If he were to go there, he might stay at Koh Kong for at least 4 days. The first things that come to Aaron's mind when hearing Koh Kong are lots of trees, a lot of nature, the ocean, and it's beautiful. Since he's never been there, he doesn't really know much about Koh Kong. However, he has heard of Koh Kong Island, Cardamom mountains, Wildlife Alliance, and he mentioned that he wants to visit all these places. In terms of his opinions on what the city of Koh Kong should organize to enhance visitors

or tourists experience, he mentioned that the distance between Phnom Penh and Koh Kong isn't that long. However, he has heard that the roads are difficult to travel on and unreliable, which is why people don't visit Koh Kong as much.

(Interview by: Chui Vanenteakbot)

### **3. Profile of a South African English Teacher (foreigner)**

Ethan is a single 21-year-old English teacher at Spring Education Center. He typically spends approximately \$8 to \$10 a day in Cambodia on transport, food, and entertainment that he likes. On average, he travels abroad twice a year, usually with 1 or 2 of his friends. And he mentioned that he has been to Cambodia and Thailand in South-East Asia so far though he has been in and out of Cambodia about 5 times. The main reason for Ethan to visit Cambodia is working and he said it's a great place to start traveling from because it's very central to South-East Asia. He plans to stay in Cambodia for another 5 years. For transportation, he uses Tuk-tuk now and he's looking to buy a bike soon. For booking apps, he sometimes uses Booking.com. In fact, he has been to Koh Kong before. He mentioned that he has been to the islands for camping in tents for about 3 days. For Koh Kong attraction, he has been to Koh Kong Krav. He has mentioned that when he got there, he had to take a boat to reach the island that took about 1 hour and 30 minutes. He described the experience as amazing and awesome, capturing many stunning pictures along the way. The water was extremely crystal blue; the sand was extremely white and soft. In fact, he referred to Koh Kong Krav as a paradise due to its natural beauty. He was not able to visit other attraction sites yet, but he'll do so sometimes in the future. Additionally, based on his experience, his trip was very nice, calm, and pleasant. He mentioned that there are plenty of activities to do and eat in the sea. He also described spending an afternoon hiking along the island and watching the sunset, which he found awesome. He also mentioned about active wildlife protection program, which he would love to visit in the future. To enhance tourism in Koh Kong, Aaron mentioned that it should be more promoted on many platforms, so tourists are aware of what Koh Kong can offer them.

(Interview by: Chui Vanenteakbot)

### **4. Profile of a Russian tourist (foreigner)**

He is a 31-year-old Russian tourist who started traveling in 2022. He mentioned that he currently has no job and is looking for one. As he stated, he began travelling abroad by himself since 2022. And he said that he has already been to every country in South-East Asia. He has been to Cambodia 6 or 7 times already. The main reason for him for visiting Cambodia is Angkor Wat in Siem Reap, and Cambodia's culture. He has already been in Phnom Penh, Cambodia for 3 months and he's planning to visit Vietnam in a week. For transportation, he hitch-hiked to explore across Cambodia. For booking apps, he used PassApp. In fact, he did not even know where Koh Kong is, what Koh Kong has, and never been there before, but he has heard about Cardamom mountains. He mentioned that it's near the border of Thailand with beautiful old forests in

South-East Asia. He would like to visit Koh Kong, but first he would like to visit Mondolkiri, Preah Vihear, Bayon Temple, and Koh Rong Island. And approximately he spends around \$40 a day in Cambodia. Since he didn't really know about Koh Kong, he could not really have an opinion on what Koh Kong lacks or how it can improve.

(Interview by: Chui Vanenteakbot)

## **5. Profile of an ACE student (local)**

Vibol is a single 18-year-old Khmer ACE student who is waiting for his visa to be processed so he can study and begin his long journey in China. He typically spends approximately \$5 a day in Cambodia because he has a tight budget. As he stated, he has only traveled abroad once with 6 or 7 family members. In South-East Asia, he has only visited Vietnam. Due to high traffic in Phnom Penh, Vibol usually goes around on his motorbike. For booking apps, he usually uses Grab. Vibol has never been to Koh Kong before, but he has heard about that province. He has done some research too because he's planning to visit there in the future. And if he were to go there, he might stay there for 3 to 4 days because he said that Koh Kong has a lot of interesting places and beautiful islands. Attractions in Koh Kong that he had heard of include plenty of places such as Tatai Waterfall, Koh Kong Safari World, Koh Kong Island, and Koh Kong Krav. He would like to visit all those interesting tourist attractions in Koh Kong. In terms of his opinions on what the city of Koh Kong should organize to enhance tourists' experience, he mentioned the lack of advertisement. He had done some research before, and it was hard for him to find useful information because there are a lot of fake and useless sources. Moreover, he also mentioned the lack of clean water or clean water shortage as well.

(Interview by: Chui Vanenteakbot)

## **6. Profile of a Limkokwing student (local)**

Thin Chitsothean is an 18-year-old Limkokwing university student who is majoring in software engineering with multimedia. He typically spends approximately \$5 a day in Cambodia. He usually travels 1 or 2 times a year with 4 members of his family. In South-East Asia, he has already been to Vietnam and Thailand for more than 1 time. He rides his motorbike to go around for transportation and he uses PassApp for booking app. He has never been to Koh Kong before, but he has heard of it. Moreover, he's also planning to visit Koh Kong, but he hasn't got the time yet. If he were to go to Koh Kong, he might stay there for 3 days. The first things that come to his mind when hearing Koh Kong are the beautiful sea and beach, and a lot of seafood as well. And he has only heard of Tatai Waterfall in all of the Koh Kong tourist attractions. In terms of his opinions on what the city of Koh Kong should organize to enhance tourists' experience, he mentioned the lack of advertisement.

(Interview by: Chui Vanenteakbot)

## **7. Profile of a group of British university graduates**



Amelia, Ava and Ivy are currently finishing their university and all of them are 23 years old. They come from the United Kingdom and are currently staying in Cambodia. They have visited Cambodia and SouthEast Asia twice and are staying in Cambodia for 2 weeks now. During their two weeks in Cambodia, they travelled around by bus, train and tuktuk. Three British friends, Amelia Ava and Ivy go overseas three times a year in a group of ten people. They have made two trips to Southeast Asia, with Cambodia being their favourite. They also mentioned that they used an app to reserve their accommodation. For instance, Booking.com. Approximately, on average, they spend 10 to 20 dollars per day in Cambodia. Moreover, they do not intend to visit Koh Kong and have not gone there. However, if they have a chance they would like to visit Koh Kong.

(Interview by: Hor Kimhong)

## **8. Profile of an American Tourist**

Chris is a restaurant worker (waiter) that is 46 years old. He is American and he made a great effort to welcome us during the interview as well. He said that he had travelled to Cambodia and Southeast Asia for the first time. The main reason he visited Cambodia was because he wanted to see his girlfriend and to view the temple in Siem Reap that he had been to in the previous several days. By now, he has been staying in Cambodia for two weeks and one day. He also mentioned that he claimed to have travelled over Cambodia by bus and tuktuk and also used booking.com for his accommodation too. Moreover, he probably spent around a hundred dollars per day or so in Cambodia. However, he has never been to Koh Kong before, but after hearing us suggest several beautiful places there, he stated he planned to return to Cambodia in eight months and definitely visit Koh Kong to experience the beautiful scenery of the province.

(Interview by: Hor Kimhong)

## **9. Profile of a German Tourist**

Adam is a retired employee that is 55 years old this year. He comes from Germany and his nationality is German. He said that he travels one time per year and travels with his wife. It is his first time visiting Cambodia and Southeast Asia. His main purpose for travelling to Cambodia was to see the country as a whole, its culture and its people. By now he has spent six days in Cambodia. He travels around Cambodia by bus and tuktuk while also making use of the German Agency during his visit and for his accommodation. He also mentioned that he had never gone to Koh Kong before and that he had no plans to go there either. However, he decided to add that he would return and visit Koh Kong if given the chance. He travels on a tight budget and has a married relationship. Lastly, he extended his welcome to us during the interview as well.

(Interview by: Hor Kimhong)

## **10. Profile of an ACE student**

Rithy Chanrith is currently a student who is 17 years old. His nationality is Cambodian. He said that he hasn't taken many trips since he was a child since he is too busy studying other languages and schoolwork,

which prevents him from taking many trips at the moment. He also mentioned that he and his four family member's vacation overseas. Usually, he only leaves to check on the health of his members when they are sick. He has visited Southeast Asia four times, starting when he was a little child. He mentioned that he had previously visited Koh Kong and stayed in a resort with a view of the island's beach. He spent one night and two days there, during which he went to the Koh Kong beach and seafood market. The seafood market was his least favourite attraction since it was very crowded, disorganised, and the stuff was too expensive, he preferred the beach. But in his opinion, Koh Kong is a bad province since only a few tourists were aware of the island's existence or the kinds of location it offers. Since the road conditions there are still not great, he believed that Koh Kong should be better organised as long as travelling.

(Interview by: Hor Kimhong)

### **11. Profile of a high school student**

Oudom is currently a high school student that is 18 years old. He comes from Cambodia and his nationality is Cambodian. He travels abroad once per year and travels with his family. He said that Thailand was the only country in Southeast Asia that he had visited. He also mentioned that he and his family had once been to Koh Kong and had stayed at a guesthouse. He spent two days and one night there. The seaside view was the attraction he had visited. He claimed that the most attraction in Koh Kong is the clear ocean that can see through. His least favourite place is the island because there are a lot of many deadly animals and insects. One thing that Koh Kong lacks is cleanliness; there is a lot of rubbish and the island is not clean enough for tourists. Finally, in order to extend and to improve his stay longer, he said that Koh Kong should take care of the road and rubbish.

(Interview by: Hor Kimhong)

### **12. Profile of an ACE student**

Meng Sea, who is 19 years old, is a student at the moment. He belongs to Cambodian descent and holds Cambodian nationality. He and his five-members family are taking a one year trip overseas. He added that he had made many trips to Southeast Asia. He said he had never been to Koh Kong before and that he plans to go there in the future. He might spend a week at Koh Kong if he travels there, because the name "Koh Kong" always makes him think of the beach and the ocean. The beach he saw via the internet is the draw about Koh Kong that he had heard regarding. Lastly, he would visit Koh Kong Krav, which he claimed had the stunning beach view, if he could get to Koh Kong.

(Interview by: Hor Kimhong)

### **13. Profile of a university student (Ly Sopanhavath)**

As someone who seldom ventures beyond the borders of my homeland, my travels abroad are a rare occurrence, typically limited to twice a year. I relish the company of companions on my journeys, preferring

groups of six or more, often consisting of my beloved family members. My overseas escapades have led me to Vietnam and Singapore in the year 2021, each visit leaving an indelible mark on my memory, while Thailand has been graced with my presence on two separate occasions. Nestled in the heart of Cambodia, I find solace in exploring my own country aboard my trusty motorcycle, with PassApp serving as my go-to mode of transportation for navigating the bustling streets. Despite my penchant for exploration, the allure of Koh Kong has eluded me thus far, but that is soon to change as I eagerly anticipate my upcoming excursion to this picturesque province next month, where I plan to spend a leisurely 2-3 days indulging in the tranquil pleasures of fishing and camping. The name "Koh Kong Krav" has been whispered in my ears with increasing frequency, sparking a curiosity that beckons me to delve deeper into its mysteries upon my arrival. At the tender age of twenty-one, I find myself navigating the tumultuous waters of academia, adopting the lifestyle of an economy traveler who prudently allocates a daily budget of around ten dollars. While my travels have taken me far and wide, I hold a special reverence for Phnom Penh, the bustling capital of Cambodia, where the warmth of its people and the plethora of attractions never fail to captivate my heart.

(Interview by: Cheam Lyhour)

#### **14. Profile of a university student (Nam Chanleaksmy)**

As someone who seldom ventures beyond the borders of my homeland, my travels abroad are a rare occurrence, typically limited to twice a year. I relish the company of companions on my journeys, preferring groups of six or more, often consisting of my beloved family members. My overseas escapades have led me to Vietnam and Singapore in the year 2021, each visit leaving an indelible mark on my memory, while Thailand has been graced with my presence on two separate occasions. Nestled in the heart of Cambodia, I find solace in exploring my own country aboard my trusty motorcycle, with PassApp serving as my go-to mode of transportation for navigating the bustling streets. Despite my penchant for exploration, the allure of Koh Kong has eluded me thus far, but that is soon to change as I eagerly anticipate my upcoming excursion to this picturesque province next month, where I plan to spend a leisurely 2-3 days indulging in the tranquil pleasures of fishing and camping. The name "Koh Kong Krav" has been whispered in my ears with increasing frequency, sparking a curiosity that beckons me to delve deeper into its mysteries upon my arrival. At the tender age of eighteen, I find myself navigating the tumultuous waters of academia, adopting the lifestyle of an economy traveler who prudently allocates a daily budget of around twenty dollars. While my travels have taken me far and wide, I hold a special reverence for Phnom Penh, the bustling capital of Cambodia, where the warmth of its people and the plethora of attractions never fail to captivate my heart.

(Interview by: Cheam Lyhour)

#### **15. Profile of an American Tourist (John)**

John, a thirty-six-year-old server working in a bustling restaurant, exudes an undeniable American charm. Throughout our interview, he displayed a remarkable eagerness to connect, going above and beyond

to ensure our comfort. He animatedly recounted his recent adventures in Southeast Asia, particularly his journey to Cambodia. His primary motivation for venturing to this exotic destination was twofold: to reunite with his fiancée and to marvel at the ancient temples nestled in Siem Reap, a city he had explored just days prior. Having spent a fortnight immersing himself in the vibrant culture of Cambodia, John regaled us with tales of traversing the country's diverse landscapes aboard buses and tuk-tuks, meticulously arranging his accommodations through platforms like booking.com. It was evident that John spared no expense during his travels, likely shelling out upwards of a hundred dollars per day to savor the richness of his experience. Despite his extensive exploration, John confessed that he had yet to set foot in Koh Kong, a picturesque province that had piqued our interest. However, fueled by our enthusiastic recommendations, he eagerly expressed his intention to return to Cambodia in eight months' time, eagerly anticipating the opportunity to venture to Koh Kong and bask in its breathtaking natural beauty.

(Interview by: Cheam Lyhour)

### **III. Conclusion**

In conclusion, the sustainable tourism efforts in Koh Kong have shown how we can grow tourism while still taking good care of nature, culture, and the people who live there. By focusing on community-based tourism and eco-friendly practices, Koh Kong has managed to keep its beautiful natural areas safe while also helping local residents earn money. Through teamwork among government groups, nonprofits, and locals, they've made sure that everyone benefits from tourism in the area. Plus, they've worked hard to preserve Koh Kong's special culture and traditions, which gives visitors a richer experience. As we look to the future, it's crucial to continue investing in ways to protect nature, support communities, and ensure that tourism continues to be a positive force for everyone in Koh Kong. Moreover, by prioritizing the long-term well-being of its ecosystems and communities, Koh Kong exemplifies a model for sustainable tourism that balances economic growth with environmental stewardship and cultural vitality. Finally, moving forward, continued investment in sustainable tourism infrastructure, capacity building, and environmental conservation efforts will be essential to sustain Koh Kong's position as a leading eco-tourism destination in Cambodia.

## IV. Recommendations

To further enhance sustainable tourism in Koh Kong, here are some recommendations that can be considered. Firstly, there should be continued investment in community-based tourism initiatives, empowering local communities to actively participate in and benefit from tourism activities. This could involve providing training and resources for community members to offer authentic cultural experiences, homestays, and guided tours, thereby fostering a deeper connection between visitors and the local way of life. Additionally, promoting eco-friendly practices and responsible tourism behaviors among tourists is essential. Educational campaigns could be implemented to raise awareness about the importance of conserving natural resources, minimizing waste, and respecting local customs and traditions. Moreover, efforts to preserve and protect Koh Kong's biodiversity and ecosystems should be prioritized. This includes implementing sustainable land management practices, establishing protected areas, and supporting wildlife conservation initiatives. Collaborative partnerships between government agencies, businesses, and local communities should be strengthened to ensure effective coordination and resource mobilization for sustainable tourism development. Furthermore, investment in infrastructure improvements, such as eco-friendly accommodations and transportation options, can enhance visitor experiences while minimizing environmental impact. Finally, ongoing monitoring and evaluation mechanisms should be established to assess the effectiveness of sustainable tourism initiatives and identify areas for improvement, ensuring that Koh Kong's tourism industry continues to thrive in a responsible and sustainable manner for years to come.

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## VI. Appendix (Survey Questionnaire)

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Group 4: Chui Vanenteakbot, Cheam lyhour, Hor komhong, Chueon liminh                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Tourism Questionnaire KOH KONG March 2024</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Hello! My name is _____ I am majoring _____ from Limkokwing University. My team and I are currently working on research about the Tourism in Koh kong. The purpose of this research is to gather sufficient and reliable information to help promote the development of _____ tourism industry.                                                                 |
| This survey task is also a part of University project in my Communications Skills class. Would it be okay to ask you some questions? I would like to assure you that your information would only be used for this research purpose, and would I ask your permission to record our interview as well? This survey would be a vital evidence for my Primary data. |
| 1. How many times a year do you travel abroad? (outside your country)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| 2. With how many people do you travel?<br>Please specify who you are travelling with: Family/ partner/ friend/ organized tour/ other (specify)                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| 3. How many times have you visited South- East Asia (Thailand, Cambodia, Vietnam, Laos, Myanmar, Indonesia, Malaysia, Singapore, Philippines) before?                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| 4. (If Foreigners) How many times have you visited Cambodia before?                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 5. What is your main reason for visiting Cambodia?                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| 6. How long will you stay in Cambodia? (If Foreigners)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| 7. By which form of transport do you use to explore Cambodia?<br>Airplane/ bus/ boat/ rental car/ taxi/ other (specify):                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 8. Do you use any booking apps?<br>For Accomodation: Booking.com /Agoda / Airbnb / others (specify)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| For Transportation: PassAp / Grab / others (specify)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| 9. Have you been to Koh Kong before?                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| • If YES:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 1) In what type of accommodation do you stay in Koh Kong?                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 2) How long have you stayed there?                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| 3) Which of these attractions have you visited?                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 4) Which attractions do you like most?                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| 5) From your experience there, what is lacking in Koh Kong?                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| • If NO:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 1) Are you planning to visit Koh Kong?                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| 2) If you were to go there, how long might you stay there for?                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| 3) What's the first thing that comes to your mind when hearing Koh Kong?                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |

|                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                |                                   |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| 4) Which attractions in Koh Kong have you heard of? Which attractions might you want to visit?                                                                                          |                                |                                   |
| 1. Total Waterfall                                                                                                                                                                      | 2. Cardamom mountains          | 3. Peam Krasop Wildlife Sanctuary |
| 4. Koh kong Safari World                                                                                                                                                                | 5. Wildlife Alliance           | 6. Octopuses Garden Diving Center |
| 7. Koh Kong Island                                                                                                                                                                      | 8. Chi Phat Ecotourism Village | 9. Koh Por Beach                  |
| 10. Koh Kong Krav                                                                                                                                                                       | 11. Koh Kong Bay Hotel         | 12. Bakhlong Beach                |
| 10. What is your nationality? (If foreigner)                                                                                                                                            |                                |                                   |
| 11. How old are you?                                                                                                                                                                    |                                |                                   |
| 12. What is your marital status? Single/ engaged/ married/ divorced/ widower                                                                                                            |                                |                                   |
| 13. What do you do? (JOB)                                                                                                                                                               |                                |                                   |
| 14. What type of traveler are you? Budget/ Economy/ First Class                                                                                                                         |                                |                                   |
| 15. Approximately how much do you spend per day in Cambodia?                                                                                                                            |                                |                                   |
| 16. Finally, is there anything else that the city of _____ should organize that would make your stay more enjoyable, or that would make you stay longer than you're planning to do now? |                                |                                   |
| Okay, that's all. I want to thank you very much for your cooperation. You have been a great help. I wish you a great stay in Cambodia and hope you will come back soon.                 |                                |                                   |

***Thank You***